

1. Document Scope and Executive Summary

This Architecture Reference Document (ARD) outlines the core policies, standard operating procedures, and governance structure.

The primary objectives of this document are to:

- * Define the Architecture department's scope, roles, and responsibilities
- * Establish standard operating procedures for architecture-related tasks and projects
- * Ensure compliance with relevant regulations, industry standards, and company policies

2. Core Policies and Standard Operating Procedures

2.1. Design Principles and Guidelines

The Architecture department adheres to the following design principles and guidelines:

- * [Company Name] Technology Stack: Utilize approved technology stacks for architecture development.
- * Modular Design: Implement modular design approaches for scalability, maintainability, and reusability.
- * API-First Development: Prioritize API-first development for seamless integration with other systems.

2.2. Architecture Review and Approval Process

The following process applies to all architecture-related deliverables:

1. Initial Submission: Architects submit their designs for review and approval.
2. Peer Review: A designated peer reviewer evaluates the design based on established criteria.
3. Managerial Approval: The architect's manager reviews and approves the design, subject to feedback from the peer reviewer.

2.3. Change Management

Changes to existing architectures or introduction of new architectures must follow this process:

1. Request for Change (RFC): Submit a formal RFC detailing the proposed changes.
2. Impact Assessment: Conduct an impact assessment to evaluate potential effects on existing systems and stakeholders.
3. Review and Approval: Obtain approval from relevant stakeholders, including management and affected teams.

3. Compliance Monitoring, Penalties, and Operational Governance

3.1. Compliance Monitoring

The Architecture department is responsible for monitoring compliance with:

- * [Company Name] policies and procedures
- * Industry standards (e.g., ISO/IEC 42010)
- * Relevant regulatory requirements (e.g., HIPAA)

3.2. Penalties for Non-Compliance

Failure to comply with the above guidelines may result in:

- * Verbal warnings
- * Written warnings
- * Performance improvement plans
- * Termination of employment, if severe or repeated non-compliance is documented

3.3. Operational Governance

The Architecture department will maintain a centralized architecture repository (CAR) for version control and collaboration. The CAR will contain:

- * Architecture designs
- * Documentation
- * Change logs

All stakeholders must adhere to the following governance structure:

1. Architecture Steering Committee: A cross-functional committee overseeing architecture-related initiatives.
2. Architecture Working Group: A technical working group focused on architecture development and implementation.

By adhering to this Architecture Reference Document, the Architecture department ensures that all projects and activities align with the organization's strategic goals and standards.